

雅思公共选修课

Essay Two: argue from both sides

Session Four



CONTENT

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Writing: marking criteria

02

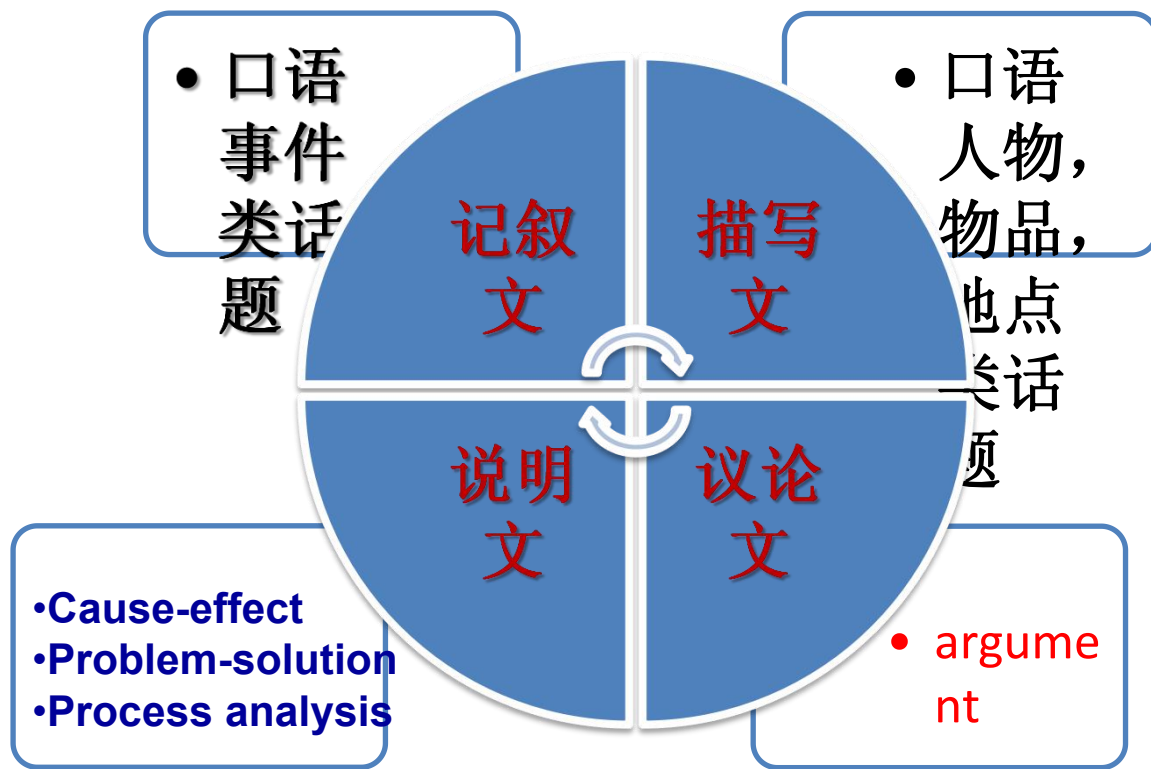
Academic language style

03

Writing: dissecting the rubric

04

Writing: organization



Task		Timing	What do I have to do?
Academic Writing	1	20 minutes	Describe visual information (e.g. a diagram, chart, graph or table).
	2	40 minutes	Write an essay. You may be asked to: • provide a solution • evaluate a problem • compare and contrast different ideas or opinions • challenge an argument or idea.



Some people believe that those who are not interested in language learning should not be required to learn a foreign language. What is your opinion?

Money for postgraduate research is limited. Therefore, some people think financial support from the government should only be provided for scientific research by postgraduate students rather than their research on less useful subjects. Do you agree or disagree?

Some people think university education should prepare students for employment while others think it should help students acquire knowledge. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

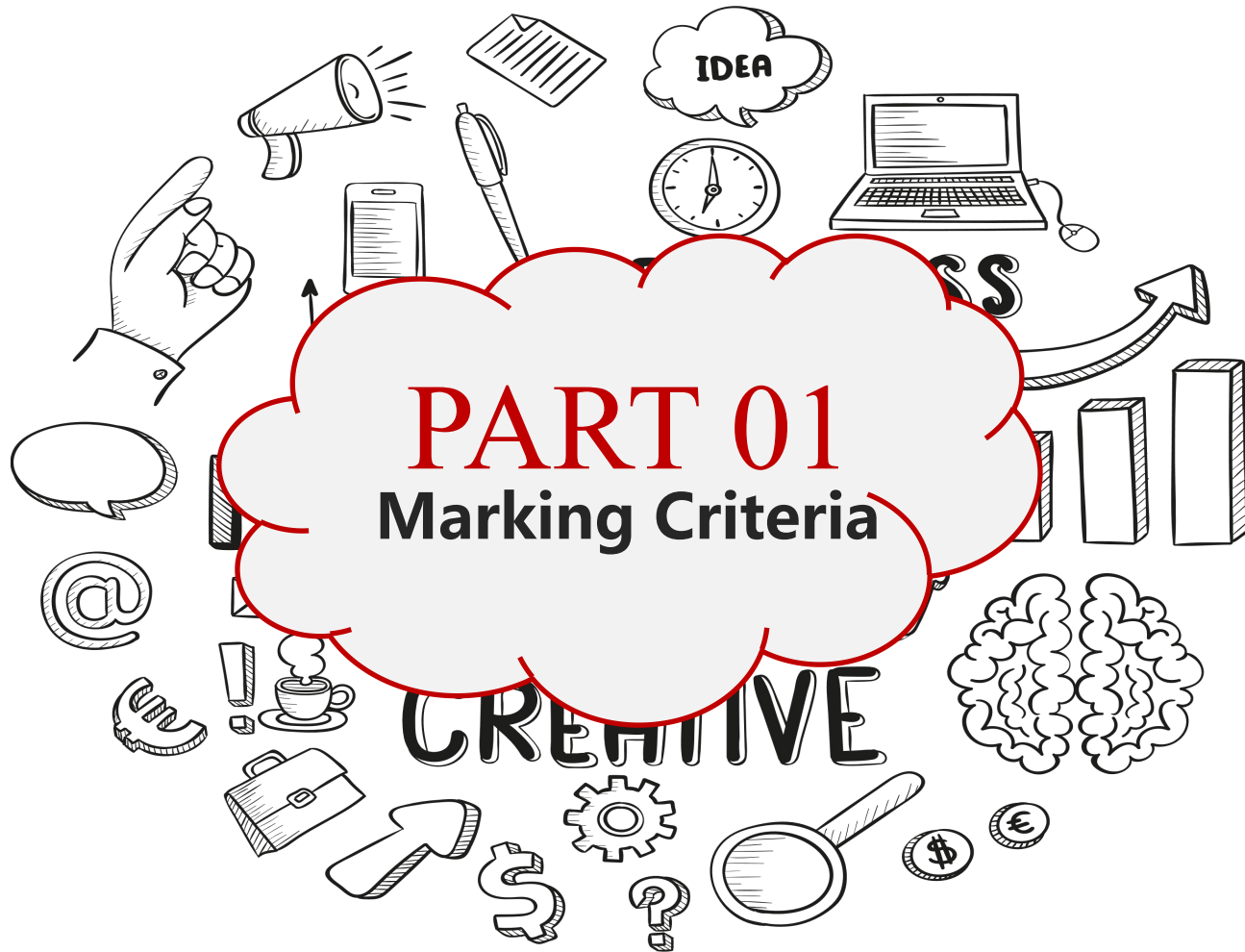


The internet has transformed the way information is shared and consumed, but it has also created problems that did not exist before. What are the most serious problems associated with the internet and what solutions can you suggest?

The number of plants and animals is declining. Describe some reasons for this problem and suggest some solutions.

The percentage of overweight children in western society has increased by almost 20% in the last ten years.

Discuss the causes and effects of this disturbing trend.



Marking Criteria

Task Response	task fulfillment; clear position; arguments; supports to arguments
Cohesion and Coherence	organization\ arrangement\ paragraphing; cohesive features
Lexical Resources	topic-related vocabulary; modifiers; flexibility, collocation; less common words (3 syllable),
Grammatical Range and Accuracy	error-free sentences; range of structures; length & complexity, style appropriateness



Task response: The model answer fully answers the question by stating **two distinct problems** caused by the internet together with relevant solutions to each problem. The serious nature of each problem is illustrated with examples. **The style is appropriate to academic writing** and the answer is at least 250 words in length.



Coherence and cohesion: The introduction contains **a clear thesis statement**. Each body paragraph deals with a different problem and its solution. Examples are signalled with logical connectives like *for example* and *such as*. The conclusion contains a clear recommendation which follows from the body.



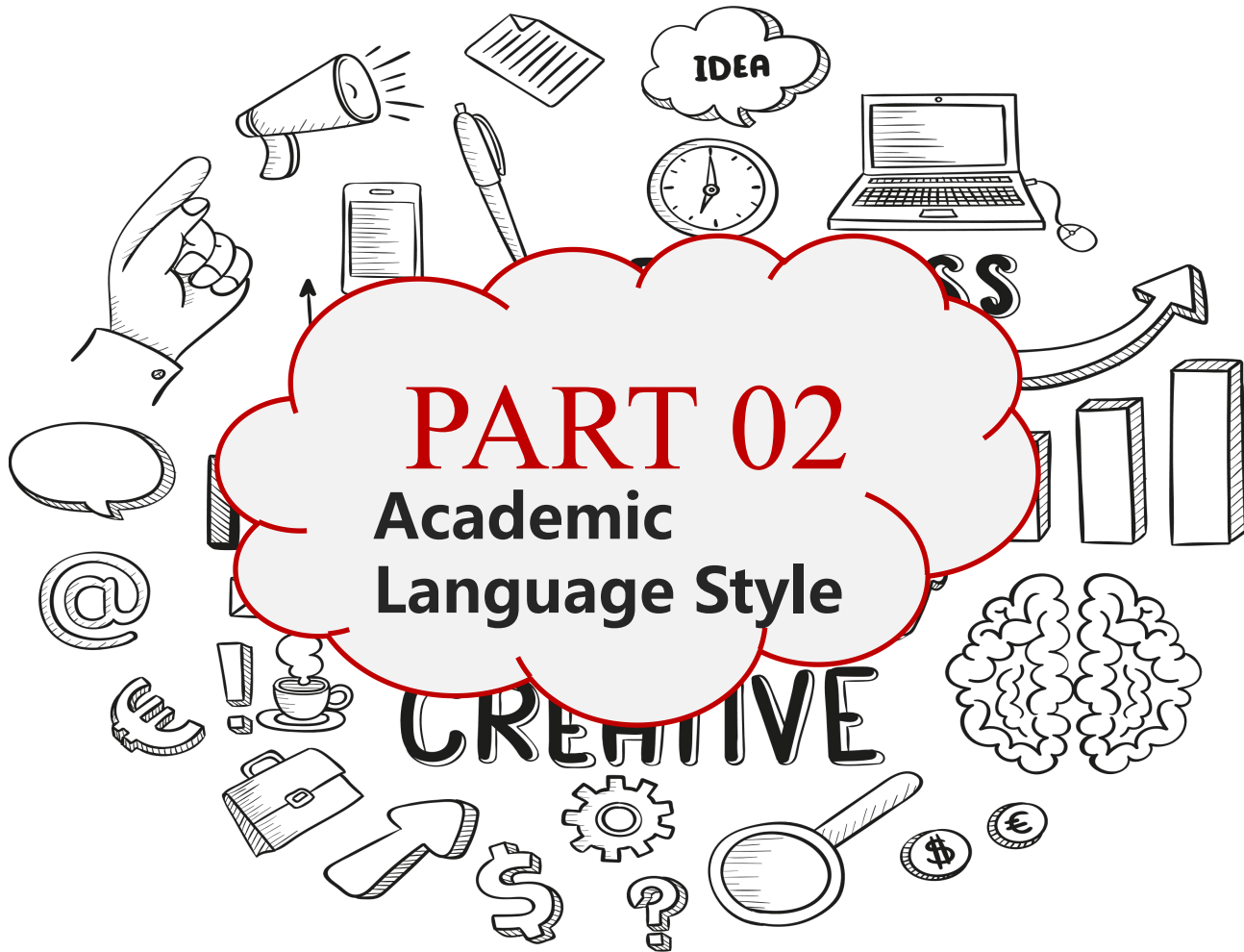
Lexical resource: There are many instances of **higher-level vocabulary** such as *prohibited*, *verified* and *oppressive*. Examples of **good collocation** include *prejudices a fair trial* and *tackle the problems*. There are no spelling errors and correct word forms are used throughout.



Grammatical range and accuracy: The candidate uses a wide range of **conjunctions** to link ideas into more complex sentences. **Where necessary, the candidate uses a shorter sentence to emphasise a point more strongly.** **Verb tenses**, including **modals**, are always accurate. **Punctuation** is handled skillfully throughout.

How do examiners read your essays?

1. Introduction: last sentence (**thesis statement**)
2. Topic sentences of each paragraph (**main points\ structure**)
3. Conclusion: quick review \ number of words
4. Randomly choose one or two body paragraphs: language quality, connective features, supports of arguments



Exercise on Stylistic Features

1. *If you use computers, you will easily get information.*

Computers give their users easy **access** to information.

The use of computers makes information easily **available**.

Computers make it easy to **acquire\ retrieve** information.

Formal	Informal
to depart	to go
to carry out/implement	to do
to provide	to give
to retain	to keep
to cease	to stop
to seek	to look for
to assist/aid	to help
to liberate	to free

Formal	Informal
to obtain	to get
to desire	to want
to require	to ask for
to function	to work
to demonstrate	to show
to reside	to live
to require	to need
to confer	to give

Formal	Informal
subsequently	next/later
immature/infantile	childish
sufficient adequate/ample	enough
further	more

Exercise on Stylistic Features

2. I think traditional face-to-face teaching will definitely be replaced by internet-based learning.

It is personally believed that internet-based learning will, presumably, be a substitute to traditional face-to-face teaching.

In my reckoning, chances are that traditional face-to-face teaching will be phased out, while internet-based learning will prevail.

Exercise on Stylistic Features

3. *In many cities of the world, traffic jams and air pollution become more and more serious. This is because of more and more private cars are used.*

The **rising levels of** congestion and air pollution found in most of the world cities can be attributed directly to the **rapidly increasing number of** private cars in use.

Exercise on Stylistic Features

4. *Then how do modern communication tools benefit us? Let's look at 3 aspects.*

The benefits afforded by modern communication tools boil down to three aspects.

Exercise on Stylistic Features

5. Just as they say, every coin has two sides. So, advertisements have both advantages and disadvantages.

The advantages of advertisements are concomitant of/with a collection of problems.

Attending the manifold advantages of advertisements are numerous problems.

3. ACADEMIC OBJECTIVITY

Academic objectivity means that the main emphasis should be on the information you convey and the arguments you are making rather than on you. Rewrite the following paragraph so that it conforms to the stylistic conventions of academic objectivity:

We don't really know what language proficiency is but many people have talked about it for a long time.

Some researchers have tried to find ways for us to make teaching and testing more communicative because that is how language works.

I think that language is something we use for communicating, not an object for us to study and we remember that when we teach and test it.

We don't really know what language proficiency is but many people have talked about it for a long time.

Language proficiency is an obscure concept to the human knowledge, albeit a subject of talk for a long time.

Some researchers have tried to find ways for us to make teaching and testing more communicative because that is how language works.

Efforts from researchers have been dedicated to the discovery of methods towards more communicative teaching and testing, for language per se works in communication.

I think that language is something we use for communicating, not an object for us to study and we remember that when we teach and test it.

It is, thus, personally believed that language is a lubricant for communication, other than an object to be studied, a fact worth remembering when language is taught or tested.



对话题的相关知识

自己的主观理解，思维加工

写作方法，技巧

语言知识



Final product: your writing

The Internet allows us to stay connected with each other no matter where we are. On the other hand, it also isolates us and encourages people not to socialise.

To what extent do you agree or disagree with these statements?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

The final part of the question is very important. It tells you what you must include in your answer.

You **must** include

- your own opinion about the statements.
- the reasons for your opinion.

You **can** include

- examples from your own personal experience. **BUT** these must be relevant to the question.

1. Instant communication (e.g. emails/text messages) means that it is difficult to escape from work.

~~2. The internet makes it easier to do your homework.~~

~~3. In my company, computers have replaced many staff and have caused more unemployment.~~

4. A friend of mine uses a social-networking site a great deal but we rarely see her.

5. Virtual friends made on the internet cannot be compared to our actual friends and family.

~~6.~~ I learned to type using a computer programme, these programmes make it easy to understand computers and make learning fun.

7. My cousin travelled for a year but kept in touch with his family every day.

~~8.~~ With more and more technological advances, our society will continue to develop faster and faster.

9. Through the internet, we can share memories with people who are far away.

审题方法

1.看提问

2.看 “元” 与换 “元”



Balanced Argument

Discuss the **advantages and disadvantage** of _____.

Discuss **both views** and give your opinion.

Do the **advantages** outweigh **disadvantages**?

必须讨论题目中的两方观点，再给出个人观点。
个人观点可以跟题目中的两个观点的某一方一致，也可以不同于它们。个人观点可以单独一段，也可以放结尾



Positional Argument

Do you agree or disagree?

To what extent do you agree or disagree?

What do you think?

What is your opinion?

表达对题目中给出的观点的意见，以
表达自己意见为主。

审题方法

Some people think money spent on the **protection of wild animals** is a **waste**, others think the **need to do so** is **urgent**. Discuss both views and show your opinion.

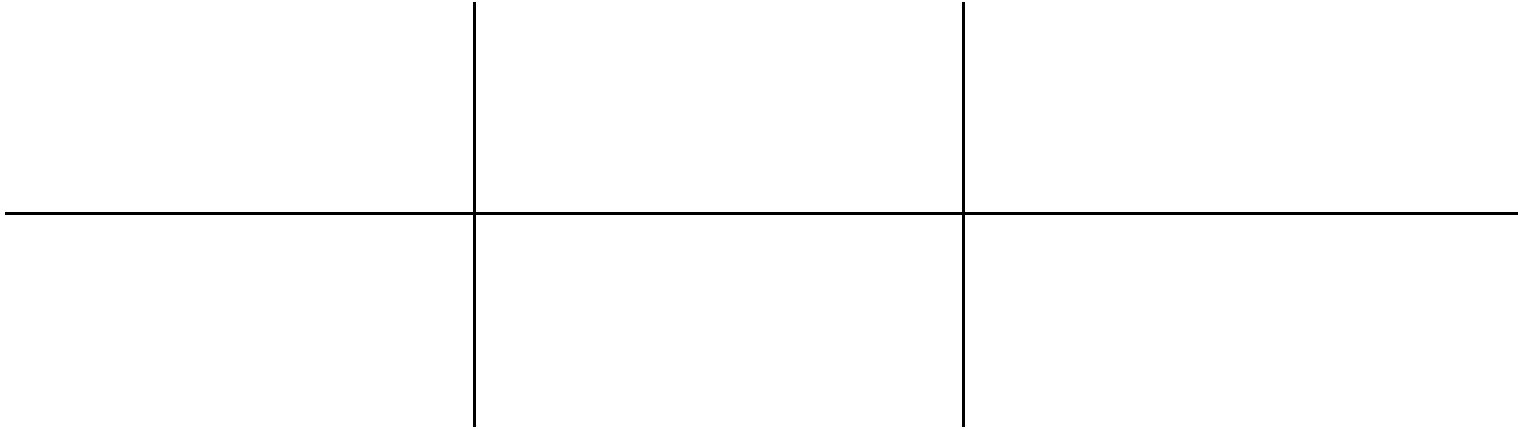
Some people think college students should live on **campus**, others think they should live at **home**. Which do you agree?

一元题例 : *Some people think money spent on **the protection of wild animals** is a waste, others think the need to do so is urgent. Discuss both views and show your opinion.*

元(文章主题词): protection of wild animals\ animal conservation
protecting wildlife\ protection of endangered species

换元可以换同义词，换词性，换下义词

Some people think advertising plays an important role in commerce. Others, however, think that they bring about many problems. Discuss both views and show your opinion.



换元

advertising

同义词: publication

换词性: advertisements, advertisers

下义词: billboard, jumbo-screen,
classified advertisement,
poster, flyer, booklet,
TV commercial, infomercial,
pop-up advertisement

Many people use distance-learning programmes to study at home while other people think that these programmes cannot bring as much benefit as attending college or university. What is your opinion?

立场论述

二元题

换元

Distance-learning programmes:

- televised courses
- massive online open courses
- extramural programmes
- tele-education
- internet-based classes

Attending colleges or universities

- traditional teaching
- lecture hall talks
- classroom teaching

Some people think money spent on the **protection of wild animals** is a **waste**, others think the **need to do so** is **urgent**. Discuss both views and show your opinion.

eco-balance	biological resources	inspire human inventions
drain much needed public funds	compete for space & resources	

Some people think **advertising** plays an important role in commerce. Others, however, think that they bring about many problems. Discuss both views and show your opinion.

消费者视角		商家视角
informative	publicise non-commercial information	promote sales
false claims	over-advertising	incur massive costs

More and more women go out to work. It is the responsibility of the government to provide staff and facilities for children of working mothers, free of charge. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Nation: •more labor force •outstanding female figures	Family: more income •Husbands: less financial pressure •Children: better conditions	Women: • income\higher status •more social contacts •own career pursuit: self-actualization
Massive public expense: •financial deficit •reduce budgets on essential needs	Children: •Less well-tended •Family: higher taxes	

Many people use distance-learning programmes to study at home while other people think that these programmes cannot bring as much benefit as attending college or university. What is your opinion?

online-courses	classroom-based teaching
tailor education to individual needs	interpersonal communication
no constraints from geospatial distance	learner-friendly environment
flexible class schedule	practical sessions and lab facilities

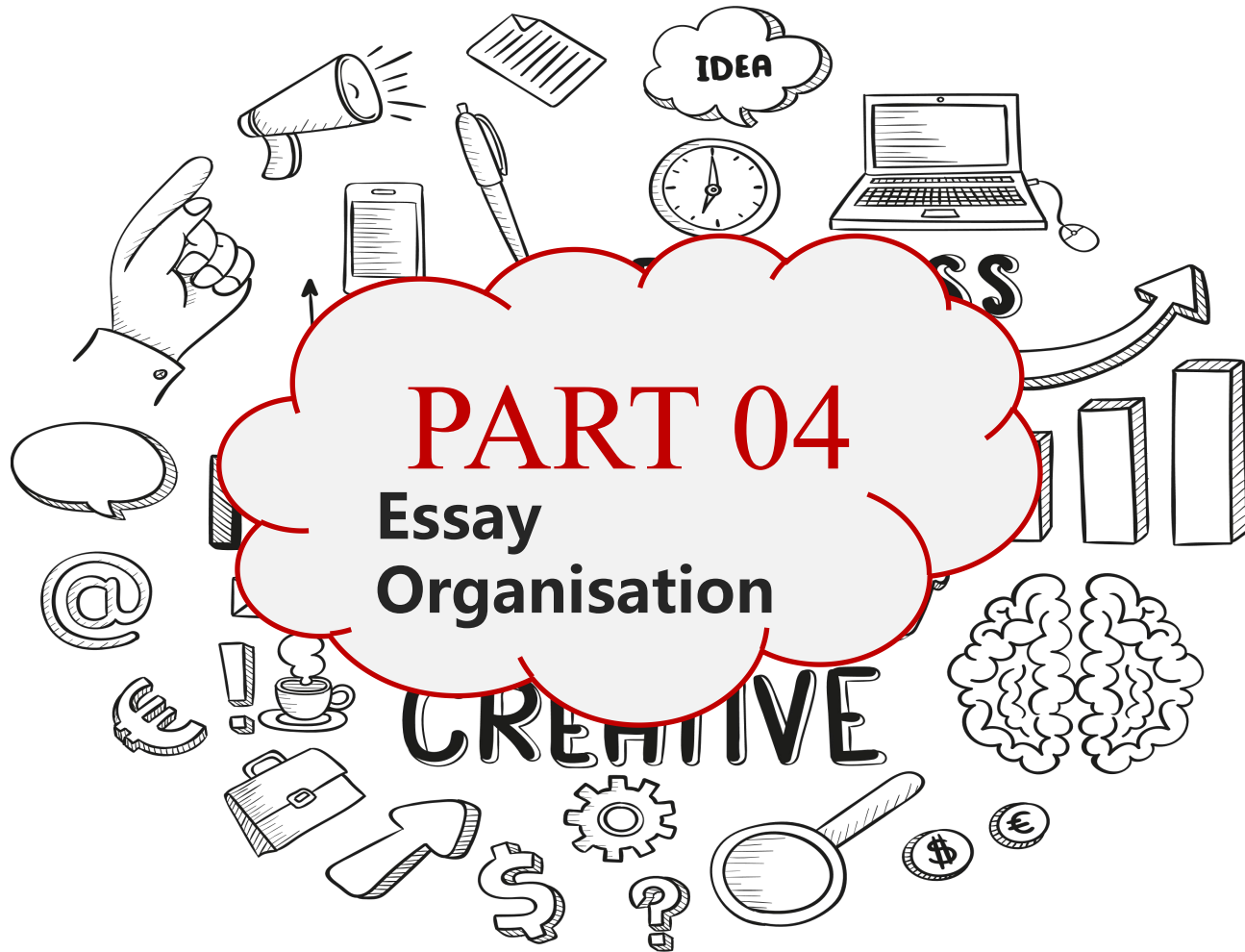
Some people think college students should live on campus, others think they should live at home. Which do you agree?

Live on campus	Live at home
No need to commute	Cut down on living expenses
Enrich social contacts	Personal space
Nurture/foster independence	Family support and supervision

First and foremost, distance-learning programmes lend possibility for students to enjoy customised education.

- ***To illustrate***: can control their own pace
- ***for example***: students with learning difficulties\ replay
- ***in contrast***: advanced learners\ skip
- ***furthermore***: make an individual programme
- ***similarly***: given that there is the wealth of resources/
more choices of preferred teaching style

- life-long education (employed people)
- better teaching resources (international MOOC providers)
- deal with conflicting time-demands
- no need to commute to college or live away from home
- equal access to quality education (less advanced areas)
- no need to get up early in the morning
- less public spending on the construction of teaching buildings and student residences



平衡式 作文的结构框架

一元题

开头

A 的坏

A 的好

我的观点：

- 可以同意 A 好也可以同意 A 坏。根据自己的意见，决定中间两段的顺序。

二元题

开头

A 的好

B 的好或者 A 的坏

我的观点：

- 可以选一边，说另一边不好
- 也可以看情况定
- 也可以中和两边

架构文章

Some people think money spent on the protection of **wild animals** is a waste, others think the need to do so is urgent. Discuss both views and show your opinion.

eco-balance	biological resources	inspiring human inventions
drain much needed public funds	compete for space & resources	

平衡式	开头	现象:野生动物数量在减少,政府花了很多资金用来保护。虽然这个现象带来了问题，好处是深远的。
	坏处	诚然，保护野生动物引发了一些问题。第一，政府要花大量的资金。(拓展)第二，动物跟人类竞争有限的空间和资源。（拓展）
	好处	但是，保护野生动物的保护还是很有必要的。第一，保护野生动物维护生态平衡。（拓展）第二,野生动物为人类的许多产业提供原材料。（拓展）第三，野生动物启发了人类的发明创造。（拓展）
	我的观点	我个人认为，虽然动物保护引发了许多问题，这些问题是可以被政府立法和监管解决的。因此，我同意保护野生动物。

架构文章

Discussion\ Balanced Argument

开头: ... **Despite the problems involved, coexistence between wildlife and human beings is a must.**

On the one hand, a chain of problems arise from the efforts to conserve wildlife.

1 花费 2 竞争空间和资源

On the other hand, animals are benefactors to the human race in a couple of ways.

1 生态平衡 2 生物资源 3 启发发明

结尾: ***On a personal note, ...***

Some people think that public libraries should only provide books. They should not waste their limited money on high-tech media such as DVD, videos and software? Do you agree or disagree?

Multi-media materials	Print-media publications
1 more appealing	1 gear to the needs of all age groups
2 eco-friendly	2 protect copyrights
3 digital information: easily transmittable \less space	3 involve less costs

平衡式	开头	现象：纸制的书正在被电子材料替代。许多公共图书馆都在减少书籍的储量，而且建立电子图书馆。虽然电子材料有多种好处，纸制书的存在还是有必要的。
	B的好处	电子材料的好处是很明显的。第一，它更加有趣。（拓展）第二，它环保。（拓展）第三，电子格式的数据非常方便。（拓展）
	A的好处	这不代表纸制书应该被电子书完全替代。第一，纸制书迎合各种人群的需求。（拓展）第二，纸制书保护版权。（拓展）第三，购买纸制书的投资更少。（拓展）
	我的观点	电子材料可以成为一种额外的选择，但不应全面替代纸制书。

1. Admittedly (诚然), the problems that come in the wake of (随...而来) animal protection are multiple.

Indeed, Truth be told, It is fair to say that...
I concede that... It is justifiable that...

2. That being said (但是), wildlife plays a pivotal role in both the eco-system and human life.

However, Nonetheless, Nevertheless

1. In my reckoning (在我看来), **problematic as animal conservation may be**, these problems can be tackled with by reasonable planning and management from the government. **With this in mind**, I am firmly convinced that protective measures of animals are not only desirable but also essential.

2. All things considered, although protecting wildlife brings forth disadvantages to the human race, these can be compensated by the multitude of benefits we reap (得到) from it. **Judging from this**, (鉴于这一点), it is advisable that efforts be made to ensure their survival.

1. It makes sense to state that libraries should provide electronic materials, which brings forth multiple advantages.

2. Nonetheless, this does not mean that paper books should be phased out all together.

2. Whether libraries should provide electronic materials or paper books **is contingent on** their main reader groups. Given that there are a fairly large number of readers who are digital immigrants, paper books should not be phased out.

On balance, both paper books and electronic materials cater to the needs of certain groups of readers. Therefore, **it is advisable that** the libraries provide access to both formats of information.

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